

- Do a puzzle
- Clean your car
- Bake from scratch
- Play a board game
- Clean your jewelry or shoes
- Look for a new job

Last, there are big activities. These are the outings you'd typically plan for, like semiannual sales, opening day at the farmer's market, or driving to the outlet mall. These can be replaced with big activities. Search your city's website for free events or volunteer at local events and concerts. Host a clothing swap when you want a closet refresh, host a Super Bowl potluck instead of throwing a full party or going out to a bar (this could be exchanged for any major event). Some other ideas could be:

- Get tickets to a museum from the library
- FaceTime a friend
- Go to the pool or playground
- Utilize an annual pass
- Declutter a room in your house
- Go for a bike ride or hike in a new place
- Take your dinner alfresco or to a new place

Shopping as an activity isn't bad, if there is a shopping activity you truly value you can budget for it! But those tend to be the exceptions, not the rule. With a little planning, you can meet your brain's need for fun without spending money.

Stress Shopping

We're all facing unique personal challenges at home and work. Add to that the aftermath of a pandemic, intense global conflicts, polarizing politics,